

Dear Sir/Madam

My name is Thuto Motsisi, and I am a Masters student in eScience at the University of the Witwatersrand. My research is supervised by Dr Seun Olukanmi and Dr Devon Jarvis.

I am conducting a research study on Natural Language Processing (NLP) for African languages titled "Evaluating Pseudo-Labeling for Setswana Emotion Classification". The purpose of this study is to improve the ability of language models to identify emotions expressed in Setswana text. Currently there is limited human-labeled Setswana data available for training and evaluating language models. This study aims to address this gap by collecting emotion labels from Setswana speakers.

You are invited to participate in a Setswana emotion-labeling task. If you choose to participate, you will be asked to read Setswana sentences and:

1. Select the emotion label that you believe best describes each sentence,
2. Provide a confidence rating indicating how certain you are about your selected emotion, and
3. Confirm whether the sentence is written in Setswana with a "Yes" or "No" response.

This study is open to native Setswana speakers between the ages of 18 and 65. Before beginning the task you will be asked to confirm that you meet these eligibility requirements. The task will take approximately 10-20 minutes, depending on the number of sentences you choose to label. The labeling task will be completed through an online web application developed using Streamlit.

The web application will generate a random user ID that you will use to access the labelling task. This user ID will not contain your name, email address or IP address. It will be used solely to track your progress across the sentence labeling task. Please save your user ID and use it to log back in for future sessions. If you lose it, you may generate a new one; however, the new user ID will not be linked to your earlier responses.

The collected responses will be stored securely in Supabase, a password-protected cloud database. Access to the research data will be restricted to the researcher and the research supervisors. Your responses will be kept confidential and will not include information that could directly identify you in the research report.

Participation in this study is strictly voluntary. You are under no obligation to participate, and you may withdraw from labeling sentences at any time without giving a reason. Choosing not to participate or withdrawing will result in no penalty or loss of any rights to which you are otherwise entitled.

The web application will save your responses when you proceed to the next page. If you wish to withdraw after your responses have been recorded, you may contact me at 2096335@students.wits.ac.za and provide your random user ID. This will allow me to identify and delete the responses associated with that ID. You may request the removal of your responses until the overall data-collection period has ended and before the final data

analysis begins. After this point your responses may already have been included in research findings. Although your individual responses can still be deleted from the database, it may no longer be possible to remove their contribution to analyses that have already been completed.

You will not receive any remuneration or other direct personal benefit for participating in this study.

The risks associated with this study are not expected to be greater than those encountered in everyday life. However, some of the Setswana sentences may contain emotional content you may find upsetting, such as sentences expressing sadness, anger, or fear.

You may skip any sentence that you do not wish to label. If you experience any distress you may take a break, stop the task and continue at another time, or withdraw from the study entirely. If you require support or counselling, free counselling services are available through LifeLine. They offer counselling through telephone calls, WhatsApp calls and video calls. Their WhatsApp contact number is 065 989 9238, and their line number is 0800 150 150.

This research study will be written up as a Masters dissertation and may also be published in academic journals or presented at academic conferences. The collected emotion labels, confidence scores and language-confirmation responses will be made public after my MSc studies, and no later than three years after the data is collected. The random user IDs will be removed before the data gets released. The report will be available on the university website. If you would like to receive a summary of this report, please contact me using the email address provided below.

This research has received ethical clearance from the University of the Witwatersrand Human Research Ethics Committee (Non-Medical). The ethics clearance number is (will insert once clearance number has been received)

If you have any questions during or afterwards about this research study, feel free to contact me at 2096335@students.wits.ac.za. If you have any concerns or complaints about the ethical procedures of this research study, you are welcome to contact the University Human Research Ethics Committee (Non-Medical), telephone +27(0) 11 717 1408, email hrecnon-medical@wits.ac.za.

Yours Sincerely,
Thuto Motsisi